



House of Representatives

General Assembly

File No. 255

February Session, 2026

House Bill No. 5461

House of Representatives, March 30, 2026

The Committee on Transportation reported through REP. BERGER-GIRVALO of the 111th Dist., Chairperson of the Committee on the part of the House, that the bill ought to pass.

**AN ACT IMPLEMENTING RECOMMENDATIONS BY THE
CONNECTICUT PORT AUTHORITY TO ELIMINATE THE FEES
ASSOCIATED WITH THE MARINE PILOT LICENSE.**

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Subsections (c) and (d) of section 15-13 of the general
2 statutes are repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof
3 (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

4 (c) Each pilot shall, upon the granting of a license, [pay a fee of thirty
5 dollars to said authority and shall] give a bond of one thousand dollars
6 to the Treasurer and the Treasurer's successors in office, with surety, to
7 the acceptance of the authority, conditioned for the faithful performance
8 of [his or her] such pilot's duties as a pilot, upon which bond suit may
9 be brought in the name of said Treasurer for the benefit of any person
10 who may suffer loss or damage, by reason of the ignorance, neglect or
11 misconduct of such pilot in the discharge of such pilot's duties. [The
12 authority shall increase such fee by fifty per cent July 1, 1985, by an
13 additional fifty per cent effective July 1, 1989, by an additional twenty-

14 five per cent effective July 1, 1991, and by an additional twenty-five per
15 cent effective July 1, 1993.]

16 (d) Each license shall expire on the last day of December following its
17 issuance and may be renewed upon application, [and payment of the
18 fee required by subsection (c) of this section,] renewal of the bond
19 required under subsection (c) of this section and proof of current federal
20 licensure as required in subsection (a) of this section.

21 Sec. 2. Subsection (d) of section 13b-59 of the general statutes is
22 repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October*
23 *1, 2026*):

24 (d) "License, permit and fee revenues" means (1) all fees and other
25 charges required by, or levied pursuant to sections 12-487, 13b-80 and
26 13b-97, subsection (b) of section 14-12, sections 14-16a, 14-21c, 14-44h
27 and 14-44i, subsection (v) of section 14-49, subsections (b) and (f) of
28 section 14-50, subdivisions (7) to (9), inclusive, of subsection (a) of
29 section 14-50a, sections 14-52, 14-58, 14-67l and 14-69, subsection (e) of
30 section 14-73, sections 14-96q and 14-103a, subsection (a) of section 14-
31 164a, subsection (a) of section 14-192, subsection (d) of section 14-270,
32 sections 14-319 and 14-320 and sections 13b-410a to 13b-410c, inclusive;
33 (2) all aeronautics, waterways, and other fees and charges required by,
34 or levied pursuant to sections 13a-80 and 13a-80a [,] and subsection (b)
35 of section 13b-42; [and subsections (c) and (d) of section 15-13;] and (3)
36 all motor vehicle related fines, penalties or other charges, as defined in
37 subsection (g) of this section;

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	October 1, 2026	15-13(c) and (d)
Sec. 2	October 1, 2026	13b-59(d)

TRA *Joint Favorable*

The following Fiscal Impact Statement and Bill Analysis are prepared for the benefit of the members of the General Assembly, solely for purposes of information, summarization and explanation and do not represent the intent of the General Assembly or either chamber thereof for any purpose. In general, fiscal impacts are based upon a variety of informational sources, including the analyst's professional knowledge. Whenever applicable, agency data is consulted as part of the analysis, however final products do not necessarily reflect an assessment from any specific department.

OFA Fiscal Note

State Impact:

Agency Affected	Fund-Effect	FY 27 \$	FY 28 \$
Connecticut Port Authority	CT Port Authority - Revenue Loss	Less than 1,000	Less than 1,000

Municipal Impact: None

Explanation

The bill results in revenue loss to the Connecticut Port Authority of less than \$1,000 annually by eliminating the fee for issuing or renewing a marine pilot license. The fee is \$105.48 and there are currently seven licensed marine pilots in the state.

The Out Years

The annualized ongoing fiscal impact identified above would continue into the future subject to the number of licensed marine pilots in the state.

OLR Bill Analysis**HB 5461*****AN ACT IMPLEMENTING RECOMMENDATIONS BY THE CONNECTICUT PORT AUTHORITY TO ELIMINATE THE FEES ASSOCIATED WITH THE MARINE PILOT LICENSE.*****SUMMARY**

This bill eliminates the fee for issuing or renewing a marine pilot license (currently \$105.48 annually).

Marine pilots are experts in local conditions and navigating specific waters who board vessels to guide them safely through their area. By law, the Connecticut Port Authority licenses marine pilots for state ports and waters, and most registered vessels must have a licensed pilot on board if they embark or disembark from a port in the state or transit the Long Island Sound.

EFFECTIVE DATE: October 1, 2026

COMMITTEE ACTION

Transportation Committee

Joint Favorable

Yea 36 Nay 0 (03/16/2026)